

Chapter 152 - Part 3

The boxed lunch from the set had two dishes and one soup, with very little rice—probably to avoid too many carbs so the actresses would look better on camera.

In the second photo, she looked exceptionally pure.

Despite having stunningly beautiful features, she had restrained all her sharpness, appearing quiet and well-behaved. She played a student quite convincingly.

Xu Qingzhu saved that photo, then scrolled through the comments.

Many were praising her for being beautiful, and occasionally some people asked what drama jiejie was filming.

But no one knew.

Even the news that Gu Yixue's new drama "Heart's Journey" had started filming hadn't been released.

Let alone who the two leads were.

After browsing through Liang Shi's fan service Weibo, Xu Qingzhu went to check the trending searches. There weren't any interesting topics.

However, Yang Shuyan had officially announced a new drama, and the official poster showed her in red clothes again.

This time Yang Shuyan was going to act in a period romance drama, paired with a female star from the same company.

Obviously, the female star's status wasn't on par with Yang Shuyan. The company was purely using Yang Shuyan to boost a newcomer.

As soon as the announcement came out, the trending topic section for Yang Shuyan was flooded by her fans.

Including the newcomer's and the company's topics—none were spared.

Fans were all cursing the trash company for being inhumane, making Yang Shuyan act in their own low-budget web drama while also having to carry and boost three newcomers. It was simply draining Yang Shuyan, and they hoped Yang Shuyan would withdraw from this drama.

But no one responded.

The fans' flame war escalated, and two or three trending topics related to Yang Shuyan were posted.

There was even one trending topic that, when clicked, showed a popular Weibo post that read:

[Instead of having Yang Shuyan boost newcomers, they might as well have Yang Shuyan act with Zhao Ying. At least both of them have solid acting skills.]

This Weibo post had thirty thousand likes.

Both Yang Shuyan's fans and Zhao Ying's fans fell silent.

But later, the two fan groups still tore into each other, continuing their usual style.

Xu Qingzhu was purely just looking. It couldn't even count as eating melons.¹ She browsed through all the trending searches, opened other apps, wandered around, then returned to the original social media app.

Liang Shi's messages had been re-marked as unread by her, but despite having OCD, she just couldn't bring herself to tap open the chat window and make that red dot disappear.

She hesitated all the way until arriving at the store. The stylist who would do her hair and makeup was already in position.

Only in the second before entering the store did she tap open the chat window and reply expressionlessly: 【Mm.】

Brief and to the point.

Xu Qingzhu handed her phone to the assistant, then quietly let the stylist do her hair and makeup.

The store was very quiet. She hadn't slept well last night. She had tried to catch up on sleep on the plane, but after closing her eyes for three minutes, she dreamed of that terrifying scene again.

After waking up, she had been reading.

Now with nothing to do, her drowsiness returned.

Perhaps because she was too exhausted, or maybe because she didn't actually fall asleep, she didn't have that dream again.

It was only a few minutes of rest, but it restored some of her energy.

The stylist had to apply three layers just to cover her dark circles—something that had never happened before.

Xu Qingzhu felt that strange things kept happening these days—the kind of strange that had no scientific explanation.

Soon, her phone vibrated slightly: 【Where are you?】

It was a message from Liang Shi.

Xu Qingzhu directly sent her location: 【Are you done filming?】

There was back-and-forth, but it had gained a layer of unfamiliarity.

Yet this unfamiliarity also came strangely.

After being frightened awake by the nightmares, Xu Qingzhu had also scrolled through their chat history in the middle of the night. It didn't seem fake at all.

They had once called each other "babe" and "wifey" so sweetly, and would argue for nearly half an hour over whether to sleep or not.

But when she looked through those sweet chat records, she didn't feel the same enthusiasm as before. She always felt like it was fake.

Like it shouldn't have happened.

All of this came too suddenly, catching Xu Qingzhu completely off guard.

And in this unfamiliar territory for Xu Qingzhu, she hadn't yet figured out a countermeasure.

Xu Qingzhu attributed this to: a vicious cycle caused by lack of sleep.

Liang Shi quickly replied: 【I took the day off today. I'm coming to find you.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【.....Why did you take the day off?】

Only after typing the words and sending the message did she belatedly realize it had a somewhat provocative tone.

Just as Xu Qingzhu was about to recall it, Liang Shi replied: 【I want to attend the banquet with you.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【.....】

She didn't recall the message above.

Combined with the ellipsis in this message, it felt like the entire screen was conveying two words—speechless.

Xu Qingzhu's first reaction was actually: 【Are you going to watch over me?】

Liang Shi replied: 【No, I just want to see you.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【.....Okay then.】

After sending this message, Xu Qingzhu didn't send anything more.

She always felt like this wasn't what she herself wanted to send.

She even tapped open that message, and after enlarging it, seeing the three words "want to see you," her heart was filled with joy.

This kind of joy couldn't deceive anyone.

Xu Qingzhu happened to see a water-blue gown. It was very beautiful.

She asked the stylist for that one.

The stylist said it was a couple's set. There was also a lake-blue gown—one was made of light gauze material, the other of matte silk.

So Xu Qingzhu had her keep both.

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1. Eating melons (吃瓜): Chinese internet slang meaning to watch drama or gossip unfold as a bystander, similar to "watching the tea" or being a spectator to drama. Derived from the image of casually eating watermelon seeds while watching something entertaining. ↩